

Rishikesh Galande

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Education

Master's in Cybersecurity, Pennsylvania State University, CGPA: 4.0/4.0

Aug '24 - May '26

Bachelor's in Information Technology, DY Patil University, CGPA: 3.2/4.0

Nov '20 - May '24

Professional Experience

Teaching Assistant, Pennsylvania State University, University Park, PA

Aug '25 - Present

- Conducted weekly Python tutorials for 40+ students, teaching automation, data analysis and security analytics to strengthen skills in threat detection and log analysis.
- Evaluated and graded 100+ coding assignments and cybersecurity labs, providing clear and detailed feedback to improve student performance.
- Assisted students in troubleshooting 30+ Python scripts and cybersecurity projects weekly, helping them build practical knowledge in security operations and problem-solving.

Project Experience

Privacy-Hardened Raspberry Pi DNS Resolver

Jul '25 - Aug '25

- Deployed a network-wide DNS sinkhole using Pi-hole and Unbound, enforcing DNSSEC validation to block malware/phishing and prevent DNS cache poisoning.
- Hardened network privacy by configuring a DNS-over-HTTPS (DoH) fallback with Cloudflared, mitigating DNS hijacking and preventing ISP traffic monitoring.
- Diagnosed and resolved DNS forwarding conflicts through traffic analysis; optimized system performance and memory utilization for low-resource hardware.
- <https://github.com/rish1keshh/ZeroShield>

Incident Response & Threat Detection Lab

Jan '25 - May '25

- Engineered a containerized SOC environment using Docker to simulate real-world attack scenarios and validate defensive security controls.
- Deployed Snort as an Intrusion Detection System (IDS) to monitor network traffic and generate alerts on malicious activity, analyzing captured packets with TCPDump.
- Developed Python automation scripts to trigger attack simulations based on the MITRE ATT&CK framework, enabling consistent testing of threat detection and response capabilities.
- <https://github.com/rish1keshh/IncidentResponseLab>

Blue Team Operations & Threat Hunting (TryHackMe)

Apr '25 - Present

- Completed 30+ hands-on blue team labs focused on the incident response lifecycle, from detection and analysis to containment and remediation.
- Leveraged Splunk (SIEM) and Wireshark to investigate and triage over 100 simulated security alerts, correlating disparate log sources to identify indicators of compromise (IOCs).
- Conducted proactive threat hunting exercises using hypotheses derived from the MITRE ATT&CK framework to uncover hidden adversary techniques within network and endpoint logs.
- <https://tryhackme.com/p/rootikesh>

Skills

Languages: Python, Shell Script, PowerShell, C, SQL

Security Tools: Wireshark, Nmap, TCPDump, OSINT Tools, Snort, Suricata, Nessus, Tenable SC, Splunk, Sentinel

Cloud Platforms: Amazon Web Services, Microsoft Azure

Operating Systems: Kali, Red Hat, CentOS, Ubuntu, Windows, Raspberry Pi

Security Concepts: Incident Response Lifecycle, Threat Hunting & Intelligence, Digital Forensics (DFIR), Network & Cloud Security, Vulnerability Management, Log Analysis & Correlation, SIEM Operations, MITRE ATT&CK Framework

Certifications

- CompTIA Security+**
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner**
- CompTIA CySA+ (Pursuing)**